

Report - ICIDS2017, 14-17 November 2017

Summary:

Around 100 participants from around 50 Universities and 20 countries.

Main fields: Computer Science, Digital Humanities, Digital Communication, Digital Art, Gaming, Journalism.

I have attended part of the DC, the workshop about the authoring tools, the keynotes and the paper presentations.

All the works were connected by a strong theoretical background in narratology and (digital) interactive storytelling. Most of them involved high-tech applications (e.g., VR, AR, MR).

A couple of open source works might be useful for the project (see 'Links').

The networking was successful. I introduced myself and our project to the community. In future, ICIDS might be an interesting showcase for presenting and publishing papers related to the storytelling aspect of the VSBID project.

Main topics:

Computational storytelling (use of ML based on narrative structures or templates).

Transmedia storytelling (based on the use of different tools/media).

Enactive storytelling (based on black-box authorship and unconscious interaction).

Embedded storytelling ('a story within a story', non-linear story. It might be the final story of the data exploration that we want to extract from the diagnosis of more than one doctor).

Evaluation of engagement (inversely proportional to immersion) and the relation between interaction and engagement.

Evaluation of the authoring and of the authoring tools (balance between advantages and constraints).

Need of a taxonomy for storytelling.

Mosaic transmedia = Modular storytelling = one piece of information itself is not informative and only combining it with other pieces it makes sense. However, depending on how you combine these pieces of information one has different stories. (using 'tags', for instance, we can make stories for different purposes, different users, or stressing different data features based on different patterns).

The use of ad-hoc narrative restrictions/constraints in story design.

Remarks:

Diversify the authoring tool based on level of understanding/competence of the audience and of the users (level of abstraction). API needed. Similarly, it is necessary to define the design parameters to adapt the stories.

Story = 1) Fabula (data) + 2) Syuzhet (structure). Two possible combinations: 1) improvised + 2) fixed or 1) authored + 2) dynamic. In the second case, story perceived more as 'experience'.

Estimating the salience of the next steps based on the current step of the story, it is possible to reduce the level of detail generated for some entity maintaining the perception complexity.

A framework for multi-participant narratives where each story can be considered as individual, as well as part of the decision-making process for creating the final story. In future, the classic surveys might be substitute with an interactive digital storytelling tool. Issue: objectivity.

The figure of the storyteller might eliminate some issues related to the authoring tool becoming himself/herself the 'authoring tool' of the authors. No customization of the authoring tool or IT tutorials needed any more.

At least two radiology survey needed to evaluate the final tool and to edit it based on the feedback.

Merging the provenance graph with the 3D (or 2.5D) images is an interface option.

Narrator role in stories (i.e., role of meta-data).

Next steps:

Keeping in touch with the rest of the community (some of them will attend the conference 'Narrative Matters').

Checking the source code of StoryPlaces and March22.

Completing the Scientific Integrity course and the Dutch course.

Writing the literature review (and a report on the CLUE model experiment?).

Working on AMI Medical Imaging (AMI) JS ToolKit for THREEJS for progressing in the PacificVis submission.

Working on a paper based on merging different branches of the provenance graph.

Attempting to submit a paper to ICIDS next year.

Links:

March22 - Textual Authoring for Interactive Narrative by Charlie Hargood

StoryPlaces - Pattern Centric Authoring - Locative Storytelling by David Millard

PageFlow - Digital Storytelling Tool

PageFlow - GitHub